

# Activity Guide

A one-page overview of the Cedarline Hybrid Mesh Firewall design exercise.

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## The scenario

Cedarline Health Group is a regional healthcare payer-provider — roughly 8,000 employees across four hospitals and thirty-one clinics, plus a claims-processing business that handles the money. Growth by acquisition (including a second data centre absorbed as-is) and a mid-flight, disorderly move to public cloud have left a fragmented security posture. After a security incident in March, the board asked what would have stopped it — and leadership still cannot answer. Budget and executive attention are approved, but explicitly temporary, and the security team is small.

## Your role

Your team acts as Cisco Solution Engineers. Work each Case Study below: for every pain point, name the Cisco product/platform that fits and write the Solution-Engineer response — how it addresses Cedarline's concern and how it helps — then bring it together as a Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

## The four Case Studies

### 1 Case Study 1 — AI Security

Cedarline is standing up AI across regulated workflows and public cloud faster than security can see it. Help them prove compliance, vet what they adopt, and get visibility and guardrails over AI traffic.

### 2 Case Study 2 — Cloud Edge

Workloads sprawl across AWS, Azure and on-prem, each with its own policy model. Contain lateral movement, prove consistent controls to auditors, and give Cedarline one place to define and enforce policy.

### 3 Case Study 3 — DC Edge — Perimeter Firewall

A mixed-vendor perimeter, an inherited rulebase and mostly-encrypted traffic leave blind spots and slow response. Restore visibility, speed the response, and modernise detection with the team they have.

### 4 Case Study 4 — Macro & Micro Segmentation

A flat data centre and fragmented Kubernetes networking invite east-west movement. Build segmentation Cedarline can adopt safely — with runtime visibility and application-dependency awareness so nothing breaks.

## How to run it

- Teams of 3–5. Each team gets a **Team Workbook**.
- Work all four Case Studies — four pain points each. For every pain point, name the **product/platform** and write the **Solution-Engineer response** (how it addresses the concern and how it helps).
- Finish by combining everything into one **Hybrid Mesh Firewall topology** — paste/draw it on the last page of the workbook.
- Suggested timing: ~10 min per Case Study, ~15 min for the topology and readout.

## Scoring — by level

**25 points per pain point → 100 per Case Study → 400 total.** Each answer is graded at one of three levels — marks reward an appropriate product **and** Solution-Engineer reasoning specific to Cedarline, not generic statements.

**Associate** 6–13

Name the right **product** and show you understand the problem.

**Professional** 14–20

Also explain **how** the product addresses the concern.

**Expert** 21–25

Also tie it to Cedarline's specifics and the **outcome**, and how it fits the wider HMF design.

**Bands:** Case Study /100 — Associate 40–64 · Professional 65–84 · Expert 85–100. Overall /400 — Associate 160–259 · Professional 260–339 · Expert 340–400. The proctor grades from the **Proctor Guide** and **Proctor Grading Guide**.